

of distinct monasteries in that area. *TuT* lists a mere twenty.<sup>1</sup> Recall that these monasteries represented different patriarchates, orders, countries and even languages. An average small city in the U.S. will likely have an Assembly of God, a Baptist church, a Bible church, a Congregational church, an Episcopal church, a Methodist church, a Presbyterian church, some kind of neo-pentecostal church, among others. How do they relate to each other? To what extent do they join forces? Even a citywide evangelistic campaign will not get them all together. Were monks in the Byzantine empire any different than pastors in the U.S.? Has human nature changed? The point I am making is that there was probably very little comparing of notes between monasteries on a subject like copying MSS.

Consider: Grigoriu, Pavlu and Protatu are listed with one MS each (for the Catholic Epistles),<sup>2</sup> none of which are  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . Karakallu and Kavso-kalyvion are listed with one each that is  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . Konstamonitu, Philotheu and Stavronikita are listed with two MSS, one  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$  and one not. Xiropotamu has two MSS, neither being  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . Pantokratoros has three, one of which is  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . Dochiariu has five MSS, none being  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . Esphigmenu also has five, one being  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . Panteleimonos is listed with seven MSS, two being  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . Dionysiu is listed with nine MSS, three being  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . Kutlumuşiu is listed with ten MSS, two being  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . Iviron is listed with twelve MSS, five being  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . Vatopediu is listed with 28 MSS, five being  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . M Lavras is listed with 52 MSS, 22 being  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$ . With the possible exception of M Lavras, there was evidently no  $\mathfrak{f}^{35}$  ‘steamroller’ at work.

But what about within a single monastery? Although MSS presently located at places like London or Paris were presumably produced elsewhere, those located at places like Mt. Athos, Patmos, Jerusalem and Sinai were probably produced right there. The monastery at Mt. Sinai is sufficiently isolated that we might expect that a good deal of ‘inbreeding’ took place. So let’s take a look at the Sinai MSS listed by *TuT*.

### *Mt. Sinai*

I will list the MSS in a descending order of ‘Alexandrishness’,<sup>3</sup> with the proviso that such an ordering is only relevant for the first seven or eight:<sup>4</sup>

<sup>1</sup> I personally visited the Mt. Athos peninsula in 2014, and can guarantee that there are twenty independent monasteries, plus a number of subordinate ones.

<sup>2</sup> *TuT* lists a MS each for Andreas and Dimitriu, but did not collate them. Esphigmenu has an added three MSS that were not collated.

<sup>3</sup> I consider a high ‘erraticity’ quotient to be a defining feature of ‘Alexandrishness’.

<sup>4</sup> *TuT* includes two 6<sup>th</sup> century uncial fragments: 0285 has one reading (of the 98) and 0296 has two. Such a scant basis only allows us to guess that they are not Byzantine.